

Computer Skills: Windows · Word · Excel

Course outline and Session 1 reference. 10 hands-on sessions, 90 minutes each.

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Course outline

How the course works

- Practical course: you do every step with the instructor
- All exams are fully practical
- The course files are a reminder of the programs, menus and key commands
- Stuck on a topic? Watch a demo on YouTube and practise again
- Excel goal: simple tables, basic calculations and charts, not becoming an expert

Course map

Part	Sessions	Topics
Windows	1–3	Desktop, taskbar, Start menu, settings, folders, Task Manager
Word	4–7	Interface, formatting, styles, tables, pictures, references
Excel	8–10	Sheets, cells, formulas, functions, charts

Session by session

#	Topic
1	Course intro and the desktop
2	Taskbar, Start menu, display and personalization
3	Folders, windows, settings, Task Manager
4	Word interface, File menu, Font, Paragraph
5	Styles, Find/Replace, pages, tables
6	Pictures, shapes, SmartArt, charts, links, header/footer, equations
7	Page Layout, References, Review, View
8	Excel sheets, cells, formatting, cell types
9	Functions: SUM, COUNT, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX, IF
10	COUNTIF, fill and fixing cells, charts, revision

How to succeed

- Attend and follow every step
- Practise after each session
- Select first, then apply a command (Word)
- Use cell addresses, never typed numbers, in formulas (Excel)
- Ask questions early

Session 1: Course intro and the desktop

Goals

- Know how the course is organised
- Recognise the desktop and its icons
- Show and hide the four main desktop icons
- Use the right-click menu to arrange the desktop and create files or folders

Operating system and desktop

- The operating system (Windows) starts first and lets other programs run
- The desktop is the main screen: background, icons, taskbar
- An icon is a small picture that points to a file, a program or a folder

The four main desktop icons

Icon	What it does
This PC	Opens hard drives and removable drives (also called My Computer)
User files	Folders for your files: pictures, music, videos
Recycle Bin	Holds deleted files and folders
Network	Shows other devices when you are connected to a network

Recycle Bin

1. Deleting a file moves it to the Recycle Bin
2. Open the Recycle Bin, right-click the file, choose Restore
3. The file returns to where it was

Careful: **Shift + Delete** removes a file permanently, without the Recycle Bin.

Show or hide desktop icons

1. Right-click an empty area of the desktop
2. Choose **Personalize**
3. Choose **Themes**
4. Click **Desktop icon settings**
5. Tick or untick the icons you want
6. Click **OK**

The right-click menu

Command	Use
View	Icon size and layout
Sort by	Order icons
Refresh	Refresh the desktop icons
New	Create a Word/Excel file, folder or shortcut
Display settings	Screen settings (Session 2)
Personalize	Background, colours, themes (Session 2)

Windows 11: some older commands are under "Show more options".

View and Sort by

Menu	Options
View	Large / Medium / Small icons
View	Auto arrange icons · Align icons to grid · Show desktop icons
Sort by	Name · Size · Item type · Date modified

Try each option, then put the desktop back the way you like it.

Check yourself and homework

- Name the four main icons
- How do you restore a deleted file?
- Where do you show the This PC icon?
- Homework: sort icons three ways; create a folder with your name; put an empty Word file in it called "Exercise1"

Next session: Session 2

- Taskbar and notification area
- Start menu and its settings
- Display settings and Personalize